**Annual Leave Utilization to Support Business Continuity** **14 April 2026**

Dear All,

Considering the current market conditions in Qatar and the need to ensure sustained business continuity, a structured approach to annual leave utilization across the organization will be implemented in 2026.

To better balance operational demands with workforce availability, the following actions will be implemented:

1. Employees who joined in 2025 or earlier will be required to fully utilize **their annual leave entitlement (as per policy) plus an extra 12 working days** between 1 January 2026 and 31 December 2026. Employees who do not have sufficient leave balances will be required to apply for unpaid leave on a non-consecutive basis. Any negative leave balances at year-end will be recovered through the December payroll.
2. Employees who joined in 2026 will be required to take **one day of unpaid leave for each completed working month** until the end of 2026.

This measure aims to proactively manage leave balances, avoid significant accruals, and ensure adequate staffing levels during critical business periods. A coordinated leave planning approach will enable departments to stagger absences effectively while maintaining service levels and operational efficiency. HR will work closely with department heads to monitor implementation and provide the necessary support to ensure alignment with business needs.

The full year leave plan of all employees is required to be submitted in Adrenalin. Please get in touch with your manager or HRBP should you have any questions.

Best Regards,

HR4U

**Annual Leave Entitlement**

| Position Grade | Number of Working Days | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Employees with 5 days/week schedule | | Employees with 6 days/week schedule | |
| | First 5 Years | After 5 (completed) years | First 5 Years | After 5 (completed) years |
| S grade positions | 25 | 27 | n/a | n/a |
| P2/T2, P1/T1 and M grade positions | 23 | 25 | 26 | 28 |
| P4/T4 and P3/T3 grade positions | 17 | 23 | 20 | 26 |

**<u>Illustrating Examples</u>**

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**Example 1: Employee – Michael**

- **Job Grade:** P1
- **Work Schedule:** 5 days per week
- **Years of Service:** 4
- **Annual Leave Entitlement:** 23 working days

In 2026, Michael is required to utilize a total of **35 working days** of leave (23 days annual entitlement plus an additional 12 days).

He carried forward **20 days** from 2025 and has already taken **10 days** of leave since the start of 2026. He plans to take an additional **25 days** during the remainder of the year.

As Michael will accrue **23 days** of annual leave in 2026, his accrued entitlement combined with the carried-over balance will be sufficient to cover the required **35 days** of leave for the year. In this example, no unpaid leave or payroll recovery will be required, provided the leave plan is executed as scheduled.

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**Example 2: Employee – Sunil**

- **Job Grade:** T3
- **Work Schedule:** 6 days per week
- **Years of Service:** 12

- **Annual Leave Entitlement:** 26 working days

In 2026, Sunil is required to utilize a total of **38 working days** of leave (26 days of annual entitlement plus an additional 12 days).

He carried forward **10 days** from 2025 and has not taken any leave since the start of 2026. He plans to take **12 days** of leave in May and **26 days** in September.

As Sunil will accrue **26 days** of annual leave in 2026, his accrued entitlement combined with the carried-forward balance of 10 days will **not be sufficient** to cover the required **38 days** of leave for the year. Accordingly, Sunil has two options:

1. Take **2 days of unpaid leave** as part of his 2026 leave plan; or
2. End the year with a **negative leave balance of 2 days**, which will be deducted from the December payroll.

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**Example 3: Employee – Hamza**

- **Job Grade:** M3
- **Work Schedule:** 5 days per week
- **Years of Service:** 9
- **Annual Leave Entitlement:** 25 working days

In 2026, Hamza is required to utilize a total of **37 working days** of leave (25 days of annual entitlement plus an additional 12 days).

He carried forward **2 days** from 2025 and has already taken **15 days** of leave since the start of 2026. He plans to take **22 days** of leave in December.

As Hamza will accrue **25 days** of annual leave in 2026, his accrued entitlement combined with the carried-forward balance of 2 days will **not be sufficient** to cover the required **37 days** of leave for the year. Accordingly, Sunil has two options:

1. Take **10 days of unpaid leave** as part of his 2026 leave plan; or
2. End the year with a **negative leave balance of 10 days**, which will be deducted from the December payroll.

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**Example 4: Employee – Maria**

- **Job Grade:** P2
- **Work Schedule:** 5 days per week
- **Years of Service:** 2+ months (joined on 1 February 2026)
- **Annual Leave Entitlement:** 23 working days (after completing the first year)

As Maria joined the organization in 2026, she is required to apply **11 days of unpaid leave** during the year, in line with the leave utilization guidelines for new joiners.

To minimize the financial impact, it is recommended that Maria applies for unpaid leave on a staggered basis, such as **one or two non-consecutive days per month**, throughout the remainder of the year.